

Saturday, 13 June 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Overcast 23° 13°	BIRMINGHAM Overcast 19° 12°	MANCHESTER Overcast 15° 12°	GLASGOW Heavy drizzle 14° 11°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

A row has erupted over how to keep the UK safe, with a former Defence Secretary claiming the current investment plan is 'well short of what is required'.

John Healey has voiced serious concerns about the government's defence strategy. This highlights ongoing tensions within the political landscape regarding national security. The debate focuses on whether enough resources are being allocated to protect the country effectively.

POLITICS · UK
- 2

More men have been jailed following the violence at a protest in Southampton last week, bringing the total to thirteen.

The disorder, which took place during a demonstration concerning Henry Nowak, saw significant unrest. Police have continued to make arrests and bring those involved to justice. This latest sentencing underscores the serious consequences for public order offences.

CRIME · UK
- 3

A British man has been jailed in the US after admitting to encouraging the suicide of an American citizen.

Dylan Phelan pleaded guilty to the charge of encouraging Travis Dyer's suicide in Louisiana last year. This case highlights the complexities of online interactions and their legal repercussions across international borders. It's a stark reminder of the serious nature of such offences.

CRIME · UK
- 4

A mother has been jailed for life for the murder of her own daughter, receiving a minimum of 19 years in prison.

Sarah Ngaba was sentenced for the murder of her daughter, Eliza. The tragic case has sent shockwaves through the community. This severe sentence reflects the gravity of the crime.

CRIME · UK
- 5

Dozens of children were put at risk due to failures in gender care at a GP clinic, an inquiry has found.

A safety inquiry into Brighton's WellBN clinic revealed 78 children may have been harmed. They were reportedly given gender medication without proper checks and safeguards. This raises serious questions about patient safety and oversight in healthcare.

HEALTH · UK

What's coming up

1 **Taylor Swift has become the youngest woman ever inducted into the Songwriters Hall of Fame, giving a tearful 21-minute speech.**

The superstar thanked her family during the emotional ceremony, marking another huge milestone in her incredible career. It's a testament to her prolific songwriting talent and impact on the music industry. What an achievement for Taylor!

ON AIR – What's your favourite Taylor Swift song, and why?

MUSIC · TODAY

2 **Alice Jolly's 'The Matchbox Girl' has won the prestigious Walter Scott historical fiction prize, described as 'the most unusual book'.**

The novel scooped the £25,000 award at the Borders Book Festival, impressing judges with its unique approach. It's a fantastic recognition for a book that clearly stands out from the crowd. Have you read it, or does it sound like something you'd pick up?

ON AIR – What's the most unusual book you've ever read, and did you enjoy it?

BOOKS · TODAY

3 **Big names like Kim Kardashian and Timothée Chalamet are starring in ambitious adverts ahead of the World Cup.**

Brands are really stepping up their game this year, competing to entertain rather than just sell. It seems they're pulling out all the stops to grab attention before the big tournament. Which celebrity would you love to see in a World Cup advert?

ON AIR – Which celebrity would you most like to see in a World Cup advert, and what product would they be selling?

TV & FILM · THIS WEEK

4 **Canadian-born artist Nora Fatehi hopes her official FIFA World Cup song will bring 'unity' as she performs at the opening ceremony.**

Fatehi will be taking to the stage in Toronto to perform her track. The World Cup opening ceremony is always a huge spectacle, and her song aims to capture the spirit of global togetherness. What do you think makes a great World Cup anthem?

ON AIR – What makes a great World Cup anthem for you – is it the beat, the message, or something else?

MUSIC · THIS WEEK

5 **Dani Dyer is making a return to Strictly, a year after she had to pull out of the show due to a broken ankle.**

The TV and social media star is hoping to finally make it past week one this time around. It's great to see her back and ready for another shot at the glitterball. Do you think she'll have better luck this year?

ON AIR – Do you think Dani Dyer will have better luck on Strictly this year, or is she destined for another mishap?

TV & FILM · THIS WEEK

On the schedule

1 Scotland's Scott McTominay is 'ready to go' for their World Cup opener against Haiti after recovering from illness.

The midfielder missed training the previous day due to an upset stomach but has now rejoined the squad. It's good news for Scotland fans, as his fitness is crucial for their campaign. Hopefully, he's back to full strength for the big game!

ON AIR – How important do you think Scott McTominay is to Scotland's chances in the World Cup?
FOOTBALL · THIS WEEK

2 Lando Norris is feeling hopeful that McLaren will be stronger in Barcelona after just edging George Russell in Friday practice.

The British driver showed promising pace, giving McLaren fans reason to be optimistic for the Grand Prix. It's always great to see our British drivers performing well on the track. Do you think Norris can challenge for the win this weekend?

ON AIR – Do you think Lando Norris can challenge for the win in Barcelona this weekend, or will it be tough for McLaren?
F1 · THIS WEEK

3 Britain's Emma Raducanu has booked her spot in the Queen's Club Championship quarter-finals with a dominant win.

She secured a straight-set victory over Romania's Sorana Cirstea, showcasing some brilliant tennis. It's fantastic to see Emma playing so well on home soil. How far do you think she can go in the tournament?

ON AIR – How far do you think Emma Raducanu can go in the Queen's Club Championship this year?
TENNIS · THIS WEEK

4 Julian Quinones of Mexico has scored the opening goal of the 2026 World Cup against South Africa in Mexico City.

The highly anticipated tournament has officially kicked off with an exciting start. Scoring the first goal is always a special moment in any World Cup. It sets the tone for the rest of the competition!

ON AIR – Do you remember who scored the opening goal in the last World Cup, and how important do you think it is to get off to a good start?
FOOTBALL · THIS WEEK

5 The opening game of the World Cup saw three red cards shown, making for a dramatic start to the tournament.

Referee Wilton Pereira Sampaio sent off two South African players and one Mexican player. It was certainly an eventful match, with plenty of talking points right from the off. Do you think referees are too quick to brandish red cards these days?

ON AIR – Do you think referees are too quick to brandish red cards in big games like the World Cup opener?
FOOTBALL · THIS WEEK

Quick hits

- 1 A delightful trend of 'community book swaps' is flourishing, encouraging neighbours to share their favourite reads.**
Little free libraries are popping up in front gardens and public spaces, creating charming hubs for literary exchange and connection. It's a lovely way to discover new authors without spending a penny.
- 2 The simple joy of 'stargazing picnics' is capturing the imagination of many, turning an evening meal into a celestial event.**
Families and friends are packing blankets and snacks to enjoy al fresco dining under the night sky, often with a telescope or binoculars handy. It's a wonderful blend of good food and cosmic wonder.
- 3 More people are embracing the rewarding craft of 'basket weaving', creating beautiful and practical items from natural materials.**
Workshops are seeing a surge in popularity as participants learn ancient techniques to turn reeds and willow into bespoke baskets, proving that traditional skills are still very much in vogue.
- 4 The charming hobby of 'train spotting' is experiencing a quiet renaissance, attracting new generations to platforms across the country.**
Enthusiasts, young and old, are taking to railway stations with notebooks and cameras, enjoying the thrill of spotting specific locomotives and capturing their power and beauty. All aboard for a bit of nostalgia!
- 5 A new appreciation for the simple artistry of 'pressed flower art' is blooming among craft enthusiasts.**
People are carefully collecting and preserving blossoms to create intricate pictures, cards, and decorative items. It's a lovely way to capture the beauty of nature year-round.
- 6 The soothing practice of 'wild swimming' is gaining popularity, with more Brits taking to rivers, lakes, and the sea for a refreshing dip.**
Beyond the physical benefits, participants often speak of the mental clarity and connection to nature that comes from immersing oneself in natural waters. Just remember to be safe and check conditions!
- 7 There's a growing buzz around 'retro computing clubs', where enthusiasts gather to restore and play with vintage computer systems.**
These clubs are a nostalgic trip down memory lane for some and a fascinating historical journey for others, preserving the early days of personal computing. Dig out that old ZX Spectrum!

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to discreetly 'testing' what in a shop before buying it, even if it's not strictly allowed?

ANSWER: THE SQUEAKINESS OF A DOG TOY, OR THE CRINKLE OF A CRISP PACKET!

Q A recent poll asked Brits what small, everyday sound instantly makes them feel productive and ready to tackle the day. What came out on top?

ANSWER: THE GENTLE HUM OF THE KETTLE BOILING FOR THAT FIRST CUPPA!

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes you hear a piece of advice, perhaps from a family member or a wise friend, and it just really sticks with you?

What's the best piece of wisdom you've ever received, and how has it helped you along the way?

- We all have those little 'comfort' foods, don't we? The ones that just instantly make us feel relaxed, happy, or nostalgic.

What's your ultimate comfort food, and what memories or feelings does it bring back for you?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Nature.** Did you know that the 'smell' of rain, particularly after a dry spell, has its own scientific name?

It's called 'petrichor', a lovely word for that earthy, fresh aroma.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** The Northern Lights, or Aurora Borealis, can actually be heard as a faint crackling sound by people standing directly underneath them, although it's very rare.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£3.8 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- A group of ferrets is known as a 'business'.
- The shortest complete sentence in the English language is 'Go'.
- Bubble wrap was originally intended to be used as 3D wallpaper.
- The deepest point in the world's oceans is the Mariana Trench, which is deeper than Mount Everest is tall.
- The human nose can remember 50,000 different scents.
- Oxford University is older than the Aztec Empire.
- The world's smallest mammal is the bumblebee bat, found in Thailand and Myanmar.
- Bananas are technically berries, but strawberries are not.

On this day

Day 164 of the year, 201 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Anthony of Padua, Doctor of the Church; Christian feast day: Aquilina; Christian feast day: Cetheus (Peregrinus); Christian feast day: Eulogius of Alexandria. Star sign Gemini, birthstone Pearl.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1934 — Uriel Jones, American drummer (died 2009)
- 1986 — Kat Dennings, American actress and comedian
- 1962 — Ally Sheedy, American actress and author
- 1981 — Chris Evans, American actor and producer
- 1940 — Bobby Freeman, American singer-songwriter, pianist, and producer (died 2017)
- 1986 — Mary-Kate Olsen, American child actress, fashion designer and businesswoman
- 1943 — Malcolm McDowell, English actor and producer
- 1988 — Cody Walker, American actor

THE DAY TODAY

- 1990 — First day of the June 1990 Mineriad in Romania. At least 240 strikers and students are arrested or killed in the chaos ensuing from the first post-Ceaușescu elections.
- 1981 — At the Trooping the Colour ceremony in London, a teenager, Marcus Sarjeant, fires six blank shots at Queen Elizabeth II.
- 2002 — The United States withdraws from the Anti-Ballistic Missile Treaty.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 2012 — A series of bombings across Iraq, including Baghdad, Hillah and Kirkuk, kills at least 93 people and wounds over 300 others.
- 1996 — Garuda Indonesia flight 865 crashes during takeoff from Fukuoka Airport, killing three people and injuring 170.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2005 — The jury acquits pop singer Michael Jackson of his charges for allegedly sexually molesting a child in 1993.
- 1996 — The Montana Freeman surrender after an 81-day standoff with FBI agents.

- 1973 — In a game versus the Philadelphia Phillies at Veterans Stadium, Los Angeles Dodgers teammates Steve Garvey, Davey Lopes, Ron Cey and Bill Russell play together as an infield for the first time, going on to set the Major League Baseball record of staying together for 8+½ years.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 165 of the year, 200 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Burchard of Meissen; Christian feast day: Caomhán of Inisheer; Christian feast day: Elisha (Roman Catholic and Lutheran); Christian feast day: Fortunatus of Naples (Roman Catholic). Star sign Gemini, birthstone Pearl.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1961 — Boy George, English singer-songwriter and producer
- 1936 — Renaldo Benson, American singer-songwriter (died 2005)
- 1945 — Rod Argent, English singer-songwriter and keyboard player
- 1959 — Marcus Miller, American bass player, composer, and producer
- 1992 — Daryl Sabara, American actor
- 1938 — Julie Felix, American-English singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 2020)
- 1993 — Gunna, American rapper
- 1939 — Colin Thubron, English journalist and author

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1945 — World War II: Filipino troops of the Philippine Commonwealth Army liberate the captured in Ilocos Sur and start the Battle of Bessang Pass in Northern Luzon.
- 1966 — The Vatican announces the abolition of the Index Librorum Prohibitorum ("index of prohibited books"), which was originally instituted in 1557.
- 1941 — June deportation: The first major wave of Soviet mass deportations of Estonians, Latvians, and Lithuanians from the occupied Baltic states begins.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1276 — While in exile in Fuzhou, away from the advancing Mongol invaders, the remnants of the Song dynasty court hold the coronation ceremony for Emperor Duanzong.
- 1940 — The Soviet Union presents an ultimatum to Lithuania, resulting in Lithuanian loss of independence.

Coming to cinemas

JUNE 2026	
FRI 19	Pixar's Toy Story 5
FRI 26	Supergirl: Woman of Tomorrow (+ IMAX); A Private Life

JULY 2026	
WED 1	Minions & Monsters
FRI 3	Shiver; Young Washington
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JUNE 2026		JULY 2026	
11 JUN – 19 JUL	FIFA World Cup (USA / Canada / Mexico)	4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
11–14 JUN	World Cup of Darts	SUN 5	British Grand Prix, Silverstone
12 JUN – 5 JUL	ICC Women's T20 World Cup (England & Wales)	16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
18–21 JUN	U.S. Open (Golf)	18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
29 JUN – 12 JUL	Wimbledon	23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
		AUGUST 2026	
		W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
		SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
		22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)